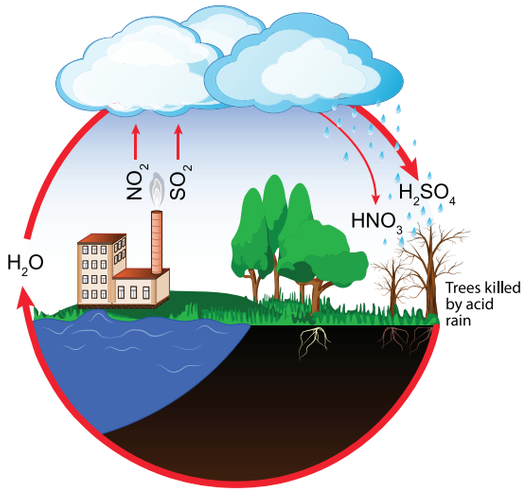


Figure 11.7 Acid rain

DO YOU KNOW?

Acid rain has pH less than 5.6 whereas pH of pure rain water is around 5.6 due to dissolution of atmospheric CO_2 in it.

11.5.1 Effects of Acid rain

Acid rain affects us in many ways. Some of the consequences are given below.

- It irritates eyes and skin of human beings.
- It inhibits germination and growth of seedlings.
- It changes the fertility of the soil, destroys plants and aquatic life.
- It causes corrosion of many buildings, bridges etc.

11.5.2 Preventive measures

Acid rain and its effects can be controlled by the following ways.

- Minimizing the usage of fossil fuel such as petrol, diesel etc.,
- Using CNG (**C**ompressed **N**atural **G**as).
- Using non-conventional source of energy.
- Proper disposal of the industrial wastes.

Points to Remember

- Oxygen exists in nature as silicates, carbonates, oxides and water. It also exists in free state as part of air in the atmosphere.
- Oxygen is a colourless and odourless gas. It dissolves sparingly in water. It is denser than air.
- Metals like magnesium, iron and sodium burn in oxygen and give basic oxides.
- Bacteria convert atmospheric nitrogen directly into soluble nitrogen compounds.
- Though nitrogen is inactive at ordinary condition, it combines with many elements at high temperature and pressure or in the presence of catalyst.
- Carbon dioxide cannot exist as a liquid at atmospheric pressure. It occurs as carbonates in nature.
- Carbon dioxide is acidic in nature and turns lime water milky. It is used in fire extinguisher.
- Global warming refers to an average increase in the temperature of the atmosphere or simply it is the warming of the earth.
- The green house gases are carbon dioxide, methane, nitrous oxide, chlorofluoro carbons, etc.

A-Z GLOSSARY

Atmosphere	Gaseous jacket that surrounds the earth.
Fixation of nitrogen	Process that converts nitrogen in the air into a nitrogen compounds.
Global warming	An average increase in the temperature of the atmosphere.
Green house effect	Trapping of radiation from the sun by green house gases in the atmosphere that leads to rise in the earth's atmospheric temperature.
Haber's process	Synthesis of ammonia from nitrogen and hydrogen with the help of catalyst under 500 atm pressure and 550°C temperature.

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